

Lawhive · Hackathon 2026



CASE BRIEF / MESSY, MILD

CASE 05

THE GYM SENT DEBT COLLECTORS AFTER ME

V. 01

LONDON 30/05/26

MESSY, MILD



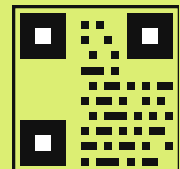
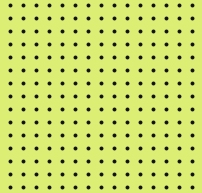
CLAIMANT

Danielle R. Brooks

30, North London



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The gym sent debt collectors after me

Danielle R. Brooks, 30, North London

PROBLEM, IN THE CLIENT'S OWN WORDS

I joined a gym chain about 14 months ago. I thought it was a 12-month contract. When I hit the 12-month mark I emailed their general enquiries address to cancel. It took them two weeks to reply and they told me I'd actually auto-renewed for another 12 months and that I needed to send written notice to a different email address.

I sent another email to the address they gave me saying I wanted to cancel. No reply. I then sent a recorded delivery letter to their registered office. Still no reply. After a month of silence I just cancelled the direct debit through my bank, I didn't know what else to do.

Now they've sent me a letter from a debt collection agency saying I owe £450 for the remaining 10 months of the 'renewed' contract. I'm really stressed about this. I don't think it's fair that they can just auto-renew my contract when I tried to cancel, especially when I couldn't even get anyone to respond to me.

Can they actually do this? I've got the original contract but the auto-renewal bit is buried in the small print.

KEY INFORMATION

Claimant	Danielle R. Brooks
Address	41 Holcombe Road, Tottenham, London N17 9LU
Contact	danielle.brooks@gmail.com, 07712 884 023
Gym	FlexFit Gyms (UK) Ltd
Gym registered office	Floor 9, 80 Cannon Street, London EC4N 6HL
Start date	14 February 2025
Disputed sum	£450

DOCUMENTS PROVIDED

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
01	gym_membership_agreement.pdf	Original membership agreement. Auto-renewal clause is in paragraph 14 of the T&Cs in small print. Contract renews for successive 12-month periods unless 30 days' written notice is given to a specific email address before the renewal date.
02	email_1_general_enquiries.pdf	Danielle's first email to the gym's general enquiries address requesting cancellation, sent at the 12-month mark.
03	email_reply_from_gym.pdf	Gym's reply two weeks later informing Danielle she's auto-renewed and providing the correct cancellation email address.
04	email_2_to_correct_email_address.pdf	

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
		Danielle's second email, this time to the correct cancellation email address (memberships@flexfit.co.uk), requesting immediate cancellation. Never received a reply.
05	recorded_delivery_letter.pdf	Letter sent to the gym's registered office requesting immediate cancellation.
06	recorded_delivery_proof.pdf	Royal Mail proof of posting and tracking confirmation. Shows as delivered.
07	debt_collection_letter.pdf	Letter from a debt collection agency acting on behalf of the gym, claiming £450 owed for the remaining 10 months.
08	bank_statements.pdf	Bank statements showing the membership Direct Debits of £45 (with a pro rata first payment), followed by the cancelled direct debit.